DECISION-MAKING THEORY

Another approach to the study of international relations is the decision-making approach. It is quite common that decisions are made at various levels and in various ways in all political and international systems. The decision-making approach tries to comprehend the complete process of decision making at national, international or comparative levels and its relation to policy formulation. This approach became more popular in the United States as there was a growing urge among the scholars to focus on decision making and governmental process. The names which came to be associated with this approach were of Richard C. Snyder, H.W. Bruck and Burton Sapin, in their monumental work *Decision-Making as an Approach to the Study of International Relations*[30] (1954) tried to provide the theoretical framework for analysis of the behaviour of actors in international relations.

They began with the assumption that the key to political action lies in the way in which decision-makers as actors define their situations and that determines the course of actions of the actors, for action taken by states in reality are the actions of those acting in the name of the state. To understand why a particular state acts in a particular manner, one has to take into consideration the manner in which the decision-makers as actors define their situation which is again built on the projected course of action as well as the reasons behind such actions. Therefore, decision-making is a "process which results in the selection from a socially defined, limited number of problematical, alternative project to bring about the particular future state of affairs envisaged by the decision-makers". There are external and internal factors which also influence the process of decision-making. The internal factors include the role of public opinion, socio-economic conditions of the people, geographical and demographic factors and others. Among the external factors the important ones are the actions reactions and counteractions of other states as a result of the decisions taken by the men in authority there. The actions of the decision-makers are also determined by three basic determinants: (i) spheres of competence, (ii) communication and information and (iii) motivation. However, there